TAMIL NADU

A LEADING WELLNESS DESTINATION

With a slew of Ayurveda centres and wellness resorts spread across the state, Tamil Nadu has emerged as the destination of choice for seekers of wellness and rejuvenation holidays.

Ayurveda—the ancient Indian science of wellness and healing—has been in vogue in Tamil Nadu since time immemorial. Ayurveda was the preferred mode of healing for many of the ruling dynasties of Tamil Nadu in the past. It finds mention in the ancient Sangam literature texts. In fact, the ancient medicine system known as Siddha owes its origins to Ayurvedic textbooks written in Tamil centuries ago. The current form of Siddha is said to have originated in Tamil Nadu around the 16th century. The origins of healing systems in Tamil Nadu are even older and find mention in texts as early as the 6th century. In modern times, Tamil Nadu has carried on this venerable tradition with an impressive number of Ayurveda hospitals and wellness centres all across the state. These cater to wellness tourists, looking to heal the time-honoured natural way.

The state of Tamil Nadu is already the leading medical tourism destination in India, making it well placed to offer wellness holidays in tranquil settings. Apart from the Ayurveda hospitals, there are many wellness resorts in Tamil Nadu which are equipped to treat chronic health conditions, in line with the treatments prescribed in the texts of Ayurveda. These wellness resorts are set along Tamil Nadu's magical coastline as well as in serene forest settings, inside lush plantations and in the balmy hill tracts. An important centre for wellness tourism in Tamil Nadu is Coimbatore, its beautiful natural setting making it an ideal spot for healing and rejuvenation. Yercaud, Coonoor and Tiruvannamalai are some other wellness destinations in the state.

Treatments that guests can expect at these wellness centres range from the full panchkarma regimen to shorter programmes focussing on detoxification and weight loss, and managing ailments like arthritis, asthma, digestive disorders, and so on. Ayurvedic therapies include the likes of abhyanga, shirodhara, and are tailormade, focussing on balancing an individual's doshas. Day treatments and therapies are also available.

Tamil Nadu is also promoting yoga in a big way. Covelong Beach near Chennai is home to the Surf, Music and Yoga Festival. Practicing yoga on the beach to the mellifluous sound of the waves of the Bay of Bengal can be a truly mesmerising experience. The Arsha Yoga Vidya Peetam Trust in Coimbatore is another major centre of yoga. The Tamil Nadu Yoga Festival is an important event and International Yoga Day is also observed enthusiastically across Tamil Nadu.

Tamil Nadu is also a major centre of homeopathy and unani medicine. Wellness tourists looking for these lines of treatment can easily avail them when visiting the state. There are several government as well as government-recognised homeopathy and unani hospitals here.

Ayurvedic hospitals and centres in the state include Agasti Ayurveda Hospital, Chennai Heritage Hospital and Sowkhya Ayurvedic Centre in Chennai and Ayurveda Retreat Hospital, Indian Ayurvedic Hospital and Punarnava Ayurveda Hospital in Coimbatore. Wellness resorts in Tamil Nadu include Anantya Resorts on the banks of Chittar Lake in Kanniyakumari District which offers a range of Ayurveda packages. Maitreyi Vedic Village and Vaidyagrama are two wellness centres in Coimbatore. Besides, many of the leading hotel and resort properties in Tamil Nadu offer their own wellness programmes and spa therapies.

As the world becomes more health conscious, Tamil Nadu is well poised to ride the trend and become the destination of choice for wellness tourists.







